

DONT BE LIQUIDITY

A GUIDE TO SMART TRADING
BY MARKETMINDTRUTH



DON'T BE THE LIQUIDITY

**How Big Players Hunt Your Stop
Loss And How To Hunt With Them**



by MarketMindTruth



© 2025 MarketMindTruth. All rights reserved.

No part of this publication may be reproduced, distributed, or transmitted in any form or by any means, including photocopying, recording, or other electronic or mechanical methods, without the prior written permission of the author, except in the case of brief quotations embodied in critical reviews and certain other noncommercial uses permitted by copyright law.

This ebook is for educational purposes only. Nothing in this document constitutes financial advice. Trading Gold (\$XAUUSD) and other financial instruments involves significant risk and is not suitable for everyone. You may lose more than your initial investment. Past performance is not indicative of future results.

The author is not a licensed financial advisor, broker, or dealer. All content is based on personal experience and opinion. Any trades you make are your own responsibility.

Always do your own research (DYOR). The author is not responsible for any trading losses you may incur.

Trade at your own risk.

Chapter 1: The Casino Always Wins (But Not Why You Think)

Imagine you're in a casino.

You think you're playing against "the casino" But the casino isn't really playing against you. The casino simply set up the rules so that statistically, over time, they always win. The house edge. The math. The game is designed for them to profit, not because they're cheating, but because the structure favors them.

The market works exactly the same way.

You think "the market" is against you. You think there's some invisible force hunting your stop loss, ruining your entries, and making sure you lose. But the market isn't some evil entity sitting in a dark room plotting your destruction.

The market is simply a place where big players need someone on the other side of their trade. And that someone is you.

Your stop loss. Your order. Your money.

You're not the player. You're the chip.

"But wait" you say. "I have a strategy. I have levels. I studied technical analysis"

Cool. So did everyone else.

And that's exactly the problem. When everyone learns the same thing, everyone does the same thing. Everyone puts their stop loss in the same place. Everyone enters at the same "obvious" level.

And when everyone is hiding in the same spot, it's very easy to find them.

This ebook is about understanding that dynamic. Not so you can complain about it. Not so you can cry "manipulation" every time you get stopped out. But so you can switch sides.

So you can stop being the liquidity and start trading with the hunters.

Let's start with a simple question: **What actually is liquidity?**



Chapter 2: Imagine You Want To Buy 1000 Cars

Let me explain liquidity with a simple analogy.

Imagine you want to buy 1000 cars. Not one. Not ten. One thousand.

You can't just walk into a dealership and say "I'll take 1000 cars please" Why not? Because the dealership might have 20 cars on the lot. Maybe 50 if they're huge.

The moment you say you need 1000 cars, what happens?

The price goes up.

Everyone knows you NEED to buy. Everyone knows you're desperate. The guy with 5 cars suddenly wants double the price. The guy with 10 cars wants triple. Supply and demand kicks in, and you're screwed.

So what do you do instead?

You buy quietly. 5 here, 10 there. You wait for people who NEED to sell, maybe they're moving, maybe they need cash, maybe they're desperate. You buy from them at a discount. You accumulate slowly, without anyone noticing.

Big players in the market do exactly the same thing.

A hedge fund wants to buy 10,000 contracts of Gold. They can't just click "buy" and get filled. There isn't enough liquidity at one price to fill that order. If they tried, the price would spike against them and they'd get a terrible average entry.

So they need sellers. Lots of them. And they need them to sell at a price that's favorable for the buyer.

Where do they find these sellers?

At your stop loss.

Think about it. You open a LONG position on Gold at 5200. You put your stop loss at 5190.

What does that stop loss actually mean?

It means: "If price drops to 5190, SELL my position"

Your stop loss is a SELL order.

And who needs sell orders?

Someone who wants to BUY.

Big players see that there are thousands of stop losses sitting below 5190. Thousands of sell orders waiting to be triggered. That's their liquidity. That's their entry.

So they push price down to 5190. All the stop losses trigger. All those sell orders flood the market. The big player is on the other side, buying everything. They get filled at a great price, with plenty of liquidity.

Then price reverses and goes up.

You're out with a loss. They're in with a perfect entry.

This isn't conspiracy. This isn't manipulation. This is just how markets work. Big players need liquidity to fill their orders, and retail stop losses are the easiest source of that liquidity.

The question is: are you going to keep being the liquidity, or are you going to understand where liquidity hides and trade accordingly?

Chapter 3: Your Stop Loss Is Not Protection. It's An Invitation.

Let me be very clear about something.

I'm not saying you shouldn't use a stop loss. You absolutely should. Trading without a stop loss is how you blow accounts and end up working at McDonald's. Ask me how I know lol.

But you need to understand what a stop loss actually IS in the eyes of the market.

To you, a stop loss is protection. It's your safety net. It's the thing that saves you from catastrophic losses.

To big players, your stop loss is an invitation.

Here's the mechanics:

You buy Gold at 5200. You set a stop loss at 5190.

In market terms, you now have two orders:

1. A LONG position from 5200.
2. A SELL order waiting at 5190 (your stop loss).

If price drops to 5190, your stop loss triggers. Your SELL order executes. You sell your position at 5190, taking a 10 pip loss.

But here's the thing: for you to SELL, someone has to BUY.

Your stop loss isn't just closing your position. It's opening (or adding to) someone else's position.

Someone is on the other side of that trade, buying what you're selling.

And if there are 10,000 retail traders with stop losses at 5190?

That's 10,000 sell orders waiting to be triggered. That's a massive pool of liquidity for anyone who wants to buy.

Big player logic: "I want to buy 5,000 contracts at a good price. I see there are 10,000 stop losses sitting at 5190. If I push price down there, all those stops trigger, I get filled on my buy order with plenty of liquidity, and then price reverses because the selling pressure was artificial, it was just stop losses, not real sellers."

This happens every day. On every asset. On every timeframe.

The stop losses trigger. The big player gets filled. Price reverses. Retail traders sit on the sidelines wondering why they "always" get stopped out before the move.

It's not bad luck. It's liquidity hunting.

Your stop loss told the market exactly where you'd be forced to sell. The market came and collected.

Chapter 4: Where Everyone Hides In The Same Place

Imagine you're playing hide and seek.

But everyone is hiding in the same closet. Because some "expert" said that closet is the best hiding spot. Everyone read the same article. Everyone watched the same YouTube video. Everyone is in the same closet.

How long do you think it takes to find everyone?

About two seconds.

Trading is exactly the same.

Every course, every YouTube video, every "trading guru" teaches the same thing:

"Put your stop loss below support."

"Put your stop loss below the swing low."

"Put your stop loss below the previous day's low."

"Put your stop loss below the round number."

So EVERYONE puts their stops there.

And big players? They know exactly where that closet is. Because they're the ones who taught retail traders to hide there in the first place.

Here are the places where liquidity ALWAYS hides:

Equal Lows (Double Bottoms). When price makes two lows at the same level, every retail trader sees "strong support" Everyone buys. Everyone puts their stop loss just below those equal lows. That's a massive liquidity pool waiting to be swept.

Equal Highs (Double Tops). Same logic, opposite direction. Everyone sees "resistance" Everyone sells. Everyone puts stops just above. Easy hunting.

Previous Day High and Low. The most obvious levels on any chart. Every trader looks at them. Every trader puts stops around them. Big players know this and hunt these levels constantly.

Round Numbers. 5000, 5100, 5200. Humans love round numbers. Retail traders put stops at round numbers. This is so predictable it's almost embarrassing.

Below/Above "Obvious" Support and Resistance. If you can see the level clearly, so can everyone else. If everyone sees it, everyone is trading it. If everyone is trading it, stop losses are piling up just beyond it.

Trendline Touches. Price bounces off a trendline. Everyone buys. Everyone puts stop loss "just below" the trendline. You know what happens next.

The pattern is simple: wherever the "textbook" tells you to put your stop, that's exactly where liquidity is hiding. And that's exactly where the hunters will go.



Chapter 5: The Hunt: Step By Step

Let me walk you through exactly what a liquidity hunt looks like.

Step 1: The Setup.

Price approaches an "obvious" level. Let's say Gold is at 5210 and there's a clear support level at 5200. Everyone sees it. Every YouTube video is talking about "support at 5200." Retail traders are buying, expecting a bounce. They all put stop losses at 5195, maybe 5190. "Just below support, for safety"

Step 2: The Anticipation.

Price gets closer to 5200. Some traders buy early. More stop losses pile up below 5200. The liquidity pool grows. Big players are watching, waiting. They see the stop losses accumulating. They know exactly where the trap is.

Step 3: The Hunt.

Price suddenly drops through 5200. It doesn't stop at support. It slices right through. 5198. 5195. 5192. Stop losses start triggering. Thousands of sell orders flood the market. Retail traders are getting stopped out left and right.

"Support failed!" they scream.

"The market is manipulated!" they cry.

"I always get stopped out!" they complain.

Step 4: The Fill.

While retail is selling (via their stop losses), big players are buying. They're absorbing all those sell orders. They're getting filled at 5192, 5190, with tons of liquidity. Exactly what they needed.

Step 5: The Snap.

Price suddenly reverses. It shoots back above 5200. Then 5210. Then 5220. Within an hour, it's at 5250.

The move you predicted? It happened.

The direction you traded? It was right.

But you? You're sitting on the sidelines with a loss.

Because you got hunted.

This is the anatomy of every liquidity sweep. Price goes where the stops are, collects them, and reverses. It happens on the 1-minute chart. It happens on the daily chart. It happens on Gold, on Forex, on Crypto, on everything.

Once you see it, you can't unsee it.

Chapter 6: How To Stop Being The Victim (And Start Hunting With Them)

You have two options.

Option A: Keep putting your stop loss where everyone else does. Keep hiding in the same closet. Keep being the chip. Keep watching price reverse right after you get stopped out. Keep complaining about manipulation.

Option B: Switch sides.

Option B requires a complete shift in how you think about the chart.

Old thinking: "Where is support? I'll buy there and put my stop below"

New thinking: "Where are the stop losses? I'll wait for them to get hunted, then I'll enter AFTER the sweep"

Old thinking: "Where should I enter?"

New thinking: "Where do THEY need my orders to fill their position?"

Old thinking: "The level broke, so I should sell"

New thinking: "The level broke, but was it a real break or just a hunt? Let me wait for confirmation"

This isn't complicated. It just requires patience and a different perspective.

Instead of entering AT the obvious level, you wait for the obvious level to get swept.

Instead of putting your stop loss just below support, you wait for price to sweep below support, THEN you enter with stop loss below the sweep.

Instead of panicking when your "level breaks" you watch to see if price snaps back. If it does, that was the hunt. Now you can trade.

The hunters need your orders to fill their positions. Stop giving them your orders at the worst possible time.

Wait for them to show their hand. Wait for the sweep. Then trade with them, not against them.



Chapter 7: The Sweep and Snap: Your New Favorite Setup

This is the setup that changed everything for me.

I stopped trying to predict where price would bounce. I stopped trying to catch the exact bottom or top. I started waiting for liquidity to get swept, then I entered after the snap.

Here's the setup, step by step:

Step 1: Find The Liquidity.

Where are the obvious stop losses? Look for equal lows (double bottoms). Look for previous day's low. Look for obvious support with multiple touches. Look for round numbers. Mark these levels. This is where liquidity is hiding.

Step 2: Wait.

Don't enter at the level. Don't try to be a hero. Just wait and watch. Let price come to the liquidity pool.

Step 3: Wait For The Sweep.

Price reaches the level and breaks through it. You see a wick pushing below. Stop losses are getting triggered. This is the sweep. The hunt is happening.

Step 4: Wait For The Snap.

Price suddenly reverses. It pushes back above the level it just broke. This should happen fast, within 1-3 candles on M15. If price breaks through and just keeps going, that's not a sweep, that's a real breakout. Abort.

But if price breaks through, wicks below, and then snaps back? That's your signal. The hunt is complete. Weak hands are out. Big players are in. The real move is starting.

Step 5: Entry.

Enter after the snap. When price is back above the level that got swept. You're now entering in the direction of the real move, after the fake move already happened.

Step 6: Stop Loss.

Put your stop loss BELOW THE WICK. Below where the sweep happened. Not below the original level, below the actual sweep. Why? Because they already hunted there. They already collected that liquidity. They don't need to go back. The wick marks the end of the hunt.

Step 7: Target.

Your target is the other side of the range, or the next liquidity pool in your direction. If you're long after a sweep of lows, target the highs. Simple.

This setup works because you're not fighting the hunters. You're not trying to predict where they'll hunt. You're simply waiting for the hunt to finish, then joining the move that follows.

Chapter 8: Why Your Stop Loss "Always" Gets Hit (And How To Fix It)

Let's talk about stop loss placement.

You've probably felt this: you enter a trade, you set your stop loss "safely" below support, and somehow price comes down, hits your stop EXACTLY, and then reverses and goes your direction.

"The market is hunting ME specifically!" you think.

No, it's not. The market doesn't know you exist. But the market DOES know where all the stop losses are clustered. And if your stop is in that cluster, you're going to get hunted with everyone else.

Where Retail Puts Stops:

"Just below support"

"5 pips below the low"

"10 pips for safety"

"Below the round number"

The Problem:

This is exactly where the hunt happens. The zone 5-20 pips below an obvious level is the killing field. This is where liquidity pools form. This is where the sweep goes.

If your stop is in the killing field, you will get killed.

Where You Should Put Stops:

Behind the last wick. Behind the place where a hunt ALREADY HAPPENED.

Example:

Support is at 5200. Price swept to 5188 yesterday and snapped back. That wick to 5188 was the hunt.

Liquidity at 5188 was already collected.

Today, price comes back to 5200. You want to go long. Where do you put your stop?

Not at 5195 (in the killing field).

Not at 5190 (still in the killing field).

At 5185 below yesterday's wick.

Why does this work?

Because they already collected liquidity at 5188. The weak hands are already out. There's no reason to go back there. The hunt is finished.

Your stop is now in "safe territory" beyond where the hunting already happened.

Is your stop wider? Yes.

Does that hurt your risk-reward? It can.

Is it worth it? Absolutely.

A 25-pip stop that doesn't get hit is infinitely better than a 10-pip stop that gets hit three times in a row.

Stop placing your stop loss where everyone else does. Place it behind the place where the hunt already happened. Let them sweep the obvious levels. Your stop is behind the sweep, safe and sound.

Chapter 9: When Hunts Are Most Dangerous (And When To Sit On Your Hands)

Liquidity hunts happen every day. But some days are worse than others.

There are certain events when the hunting goes into overdrive. When the sweeps are bigger, faster, and more violent. When even good levels get destroyed because the volatility is just too extreme.

These are the days when you should either sit out completely or reduce your risk dramatically.

CPI Day (Consumer Price Index):

Inflation data comes out. The market reacts instantly. Price might spike 50-100 pips in one direction, sweep every stop loss in sight, then reverse 50-100 pips the other way. All within 5 minutes.

This isn't trading. This is a casino.

FOMC Day (Federal Reserve Meeting):

The Fed announces interest rate decisions. One word from the Fed chair can move Gold 80 pips. The first move is almost always a fake. They sweep one direction, then reverse. Classic hunt on steroids.

NFP Day (Non-Farm Payrolls):

Employment data. High volatility. Same pattern, big spike, big sweep, big reversal.

What To Do On These Days:

Option A: Sit on your hands.

Don't trade. Close your laptop. Go for a walk. Let the gamblers fight it out. Let THEM be the liquidity. You can trade tomorrow when the chaos is over.

Option B: Wait 30-60 minutes.

Let the initial spike happen. Let the sweep happen. Let the fake move play out. THEN look for your setup. Often the best entries come 30-60 minutes after the news, when the dust settles and the real direction reveals itself.

Option C: Size down dramatically.

If you absolutely must trade, use 25% of your normal risk. Tiny position. Almost not worth it. But it keeps you in the game without destroying your account if you're wrong.

My preference? Option A.

I've learned the hard way that trading news is a losing game for me. The moves are too fast, the sweeps are too violent, and the risk-reward is often terrible.

I'd rather let the news pass, see where the bodies are buried, and trade the aftermath with a clear picture. You don't have to trade every day. You don't have to be in every move. Sometimes the best trade is no trade.



Chapter 10: Reading The Chart Like A Hunter

The goal of this ebook is to change how you see the chart.

Before, you looked at the chart and asked:

"Where is support?"

"Where is resistance?"

"Where should I enter?"

"Where should I put my stop?"

Now, you should look at the chart and ask:

"Where are the stop losses?"

"Where is liquidity hiding?"

"Where will THEY need to go to get filled?"

"Has the sweep already happened, or is it coming?"

This is a complete mental shift. You stop being the prey and start thinking like the predator.

Exercise: Next time you open a chart, do this:

1. Don't look for "support" or "resistance"
2. Instead, mark every place where you think OTHER traders would put their stop losses.
3. Mark equal lows. Mark equal highs. Mark previous day high/low. Mark obvious swing points. Mark round numbers.
4. These are your "liquidity pools"
5. Now ask: "Has price swept any of these recently?"

If yes: the sweep already happened. The hunt is done. Look for entries in the direction of the snap.

If no: the sweep is probably coming. Don't enter yet. Wait for the hunt.

This simple exercise will change how you trade.

You'll stop entering at obvious levels and getting stopped out.

You'll start waiting for the obvious levels to get swept.

You'll enter after the hunt, with the real move.

The market is always hunting liquidity. Once you see where liquidity hides, you can anticipate the hunt.

And once you can anticipate the hunt, you can trade the aftermath

Chapter 11: Real Examples

Let me show you what this looks like in practice.

Example 1: Equal Lows Sweep Into Rally.

Gold made two lows at 5150. Perfect equal lows. Everyone saw "double bottom support" Everyone bought. Everyone put stops below 5150.

I marked 5150 as a liquidity pool. Below those equal lows were thousands of stop losses.

Price dropped to 5142, sweeping all the stops. Long wick below 5150. Retail traders stopped out, screaming "support failed!"

But price immediately snapped back above 5150. Within two candles, we were back at 5155.

I entered long at 5156 after the snap. Stop loss at 5140 (below the wick). Target was the high of the range at 5220.

Result: 64 pips profit on a setup that most traders would have lost money on because they entered at the obvious level instead of waiting for the sweep.

Example 2: Previous Day Low Hunt.

Previous day low was 5180. Obvious level. Every retail trader watching it.

During London session, price dropped to 5175, sweeping the PDL. Five pip wick below. All the stops below 5180 got hit.

Price snapped back above 5180 within 15 minutes.

Entry: 5183 after the snap. Stop: 5173 (below the wick). Target: Previous day high at 5240.

Result: 57 pips. The "breakdown" was fake. It was just a hunt.

Example 3: News Spike Trap.

CPI day. Gold sitting at 5200 before the data.

CPI comes out. Gold spikes down to 5170 in seconds. Everyone thinks "bearish CPI, Gold dumping!" Some traders short the breakdown.

But the spike was the hunt. 30 pips of stop losses just got swept.

Price reverses. Within an hour, Gold is at 5250. The shorts who entered on the "breakdown" are now trapped. The longs who got stopped out at 5170 are watching from the sidelines.

I didn't trade the initial spike. I waited. I watched. After 45 minutes, price had clearly reversed. I entered long at 5215 with stop at 5190.

Result: 35 pips on a day when most traders either got stopped out or trapped on the wrong side.

The pattern is the same every time. Liquidity gets hunted. Price sweeps through the obvious level.

Then it reverses and the real move begins.

Your job is to wait for the sweep. Then trade the aftermath.

Chapter 12: Don't Be The Liquidity: The Rules

Let me leave you with the rules I trade by. Print these out. Put them next to your screen. Read them before every trade.

Rule 1: If the level is obvious, the liquidity below or above it is obvious too.

Obvious levels get hunted. Period. Don't enter at obvious levels. Wait for the sweep.

Rule 2: The first move is usually the trap.

Especially on news. Especially on New York open. Especially on any high-volatility moment. The first spike is usually the hunt. The real move comes after.

Rule 3: Enter after the sweep, not before.

Don't try to be a hero. Don't try to catch the exact bottom. Wait for the hunt to finish. Enter on the snap. Your entry will be slightly worse, but your win rate will be dramatically better.

Rule 4: Put your stop loss behind the wick, not behind the level.

Behind the place where the hunt already happened. Not in the killing field where the next hunt will happen. Wider stop, but a stop that actually holds.

Rule 5: If you can't spot the liquidity, you are the liquidity.

Before every trade, ask yourself: "Where are the stop losses? Where is the liquidity pool?" If you don't know, you're probably standing in it.

Rule 6: The market needs your orders to move.

Big players need liquidity to fill their positions. They need YOUR stop loss to trigger so they can enter. Don't give it to them for free. Make them work for it. And when they do hunt, be ready to trade the other side.

Rule 7: Being out of the market is also a position.

You don't have to trade every day. You don't have to catch every move. Sometimes the best trade is no trade. Especially on news days. Especially when the chart is unclear. Let others be the liquidity. Protect your capital. That's it. Seven rules.

Follow them and you'll stop being the chip. You'll stop hiding in the same closet as everyone else. You'll stop getting stopped out right before the move.

You'll start trading with the hunters instead of against them.

The market will always hunt liquidity. That's how it works. That's how big players fill their orders.

Your job is simple: don't be the liquidity.

See the hunt. Wait for the hunt. Trade the aftermath.

That's the game.

Now go play it. 

MarketMindTruth



About The Author

MarketMindTruth

I trade Gold. Every morning I post my levels.

No face. No Lambos. No fake lifestyle. No guru energy. Just the chart, the levels, and the process.

I built my edge on Fixed Range Volume Profile, Auction Theory, and understanding where liquidity hides. This ebook is part of that process, teaching you to stop being the exit liquidity and start trading with the hunters.

Find me on X (Twitter):

@MarketMindTruth

More from MarketMindTruth:

"The Gold Auction" Your complete guide to trading \$XAUUSD using Fixed Range Volume Profile. The full breakdown of my method, from Auction Theory to execution on M15.

Connect:

X: @MarketMindTruth

Content: Daily Gold maps, weekly proof, educational threads.

"If you can't spot the liquidity on the chart, you are the liquidity."

